

Paradiem

The Morning Brief

SEPTEMBER 26, 2026

Hormuz Watch

Weekend Edition — Iran seven-day plan awaits US response as oil slides, semis recover into Friday close, and Michigan sentiment falls sharply.

S&P 500 (SPY, FRI CLOSE) \$771.35 · ↑~1.27% on the week	NASDAQ (QQQ) / DOW (DIA, FRI) \$744.50 ↑~3.19% wk / \$517.49 ↑~0.31% wk	WTI (USO) / BRENT (BNO, FRI) \$148.33 ↓~3.57% wk / \$59.65 ↓~1.52% wk	BITCOIN (LIVE) / IBIT (FRI) Reportedly ~\$83.8K per prediction—market reads · IBIT \$47.57 Fri	FEAR & GREED (CNN STOCK) Reportedly ~35 Fear per Benzinga · Drop reads 74 crypto fallback
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SECTION 01

Markets — Week in Review: Semi Rebound Frames a Reported Green Week Against Elevated Yields

ALL THREE MAJOR INDICES REPORTEDLY POST WEEKLY GAINS AS CHIP LEADERSHIP AND OIL PULLBACK OFFSET DURATION COMPRESSION

Per data drop and per Yahoo Finance, CNBC, and Columbian coverage of the weekly recap, the week reportedly closed with SPY approximately ↑1.27% at \$771.35, QQQ approximately ↑3.19% at \$744.50, and DIA approximately ↑0.31% at \$517.49 for a reported broadly green week (with the reported S&P 500 index near approximately +0.6% on the week and the Dow reportedly snapping a reported three-week losing streak per Yahoo Finance coverage). Per Fox News, Bloomberg, Semafor, and Japan Times coverage of the Friday UNGA-sidelines diplomatic sequence, the reported energy layer reportedly reversed the week’s bid Friday with the reported US-Iran Hormuz phased-deal reporting reportedly driving WTI (USO) approximately ↓3.57% on the week to \$148.33 and Brent (BNO) approximately ↓1.52% on the week to \$59.65. Per data drop, the reported Growth-Hybrid semiconductor leadership reportedly anchored the weekly advance with a Monday reported AMD trillion-dollar handle followed by mid-week duration compression on the reported flash PMI beats and a reported Friday chip-and-connector recovery. Per University of Michigan release coverage carried through Advisor Perspectives and Quartz, the reported final September consumer sentiment print reportedly fell to approximately 48.1 (reportedly the lowest reading in four months), framing the reported household-signal setup into the reported October 2 payrolls print. Per data drop, Carson’s active SPY support level at \$645.80 (retracement target set April 13) remains untouched, with Friday’s reported intraday low of \$766.29 well above that level.

S&P 500 (SPY, FRI CLOSE)	\$771.35 · ↑~1.27% wk from prior Fri close per data drop
NASDAQ (QQQ) / DOW (DIA, FRI)	\$744.50 ↑~3.19% wk / \$517.49 ↑~0.31% wk per data drop
10-YEAR YIELD / TLT (FRI)	Reportedly ~5.18% per Yahoo Finance / \$79.32 ↓0.13% per data drop
WTI (USO) / BRENT (BNO, FRI)	\$148.33 ↓~3.57% wk / \$59.65 ↓~1.52% wk per data drop
FED OCT 27–28 HIKE ODDS	Reportedly ~75.8% for +25 bp per CME FedWatch coverage
MICHIGAN SENTIMENT (FINAL SEP)	Reportedly ~48.1 · ↓7.0% MoM per University of Michigan release
CARSON'S ACTIVE SPY SUPPORT	\$645.80 retracement target · Untouched (Fri low \$766.29)

HOUSEHOLD SIGNAL REPORTEDLY WEAKENS AS INFLATION EXPECTATIONS REPORTEDLY RISE; FED PATH REPORTEDLY STAYS HAWKISH INTO THE REPORTED OCTOBER 27–28 MEETING

Per University of Michigan release coverage carried through Advisor Perspectives, Quartz, and Trading Economics, the reported final September consumer sentiment print reportedly fell to approximately 48.1 (reportedly a 7.0% month-over-month decrease), with the reported one-year inflation

expectation reportedly rising from approximately 4.0% to approximately 4.6% and the reported five-year expectation reportedly edging up to approximately 3.4%. Per Census Bureau coverage of the August advance report released Friday, reported new orders for durable goods reportedly came in near approximately \$338.6 billion (reportedly essentially unchanged from July), with reported orders ex-transportation reportedly up approximately +0.3% — a reported mixed factory read against the reported flash PMI beats mid-week. Per Growbeansprout and CNBC coverage of the reported CME FedWatch tape, reported October 27–28 hike odds reportedly sit near approximately 75.8% for a reported +25 bp move, anchored by reported Fed Governor Michael Barr's hawkish read carried mid-week and reinforced by the reported PMI print. For FCI positioning, the composition — a reported sentiment decline alongside reported inflation-expectations lift, a reported essentially-flat Durable Goods print, and a reported hawkish-skewed Fed path into the reported October payrolls week — keeps CHD, CL, ABT, SYK, DGX, ADP, SPGI, and the FCI Dividend duration-and-consumer sleeve reading through the reported household channel and the reported October 27–28 FOMC meeting.

A week that opened with a reported AMD trillion-dollar handle, absorbed a reported flash PMI beat, ran through a reported Xi state dinner reportedly cordial but light on new deliverables beyond the reported January 10 truce extension, and closed Friday with a reported semiconductor recovery alongside a reported oil pullback on reported Hormuz-diplomacy hopes frames a weekend tape that tends to reward reading each catalyst on its own terms rather than compositing a single directional view. Research reveals opportunities.

Geopolitics — Iran Lays Down a Seven-Day Hormuz Plan; WSJ Reportedly Frames Trump as Rejecting a Peace Plan

ARAQCHI REPORTEDLY PUBLISHES A SEVEN-DAY HORMUZ TIMETABLE AT THE UNGA SIDELINES — US REPORTEDLY WEIGHS RESPONSE OVER THE WEEKEND

Per Fox News, Bloomberg, US News, Semafor, Japan Times, and BusinessMirror coverage of the Friday New York UNGA-sidelines diplomatic sequence, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araqchi reportedly presented a reported seven-day step-by-step framework under which Washington would first reportedly have four-to-five days to take reported previously-agreed steps drawn from a reported prior US-Iran memorandum of understanding, the reported Strait of Hormuz would then reportedly reopen on the reported sixth day, and reported broader negotiations would reportedly begin one day later. Per the same coverage, Araqchi reportedly stated the seven-day timeline would begin as soon as the reported US accepts the plan. Per data drop headlines, one Reuters piece reportedly framed Iran as awaiting a US move after a reported Wall Street Journal report reportedly framed President Trump as rejecting a reported peace plan, and per separate Reuters coverage carried in the drop, another piece reportedly framed Iran as making no reported nuclear concessions per Iranian officials — framing a reported diplomatic-ceiling constraint alongside the reported Hormuz sequencing offer. Per data drop, Friday's energy tape reportedly reflected the reported phased-deal optics with WTI (USO) approximately $\downarrow 3.11\%$ at \$148.33, Brent (BNO) approximately $\downarrow 3.54\%$ at \$59.65, and Nat Gas (UNG) approximately $\downarrow 3.64\%$ at \$11.13. For FCI positioning, the composition — a reported Iranian seven-day proposal, a reported WSJ-framed Trump rejection ahead of the reported weekend response window, a reported Qatari-mediated backchannel per Bloomberg and Semafor coverage, and a reported Friday oil pullback reportedly discounting a partial de-escalation path — keeps CVX, OKE, CNX, LMT, and GD reading through the intersection of the reported physical-crude signal, the reported sanctions perimeter (with the reported UN snapback measures reportedly in force per prior-brief coverage), and the reported Fed rate path into the Monday setup.

HOUTHI MISSILE-AND-DRONE ATTACK ON SAUDI ARABIA REPORTEDLY INTERCEPTED — REGIONAL ATTACK LAYER REPORTEDLY REMAINS LIVE BEHIND THE HORMUZ TRACK

Per Reuters coverage carried in the data drop headlines, one piece reportedly framed the Saudi-led coalition as reportedly intercepting a reported Houthi missile-and-drone salvo — a reported reminder that the reported Yemen-based attack layer sitting behind the reported Iran-US Hormuz negotiation reportedly remains active into the weekend. Per separate Reuters coverage carried in the drop, one piece reportedly framed the week as a reported turbulent one for UN diplomacy with reported six big takeaways, and per an additional Reuters piece carried in the drop, another piece reportedly framed how President Trump's reported diplomatic week reportedly exposed the reported limits of his power. Per data drop, LMT reportedly closed Friday approximately $\downarrow 0.79\%$ at \$519.56 and GD reportedly closed essentially flat at \$336.72, reflecting a reported light defense reaction into the Friday close against the reported still-live regional-attack backdrop, and per data drop holdings news, one piece reportedly framed LMT as receiving reported first Patriot parts from GM alongside reported missile-output scaling

questions. For FCI positioning, the composition — a reported Iranian-track Hormuz sequencing offer alongside a reported Houthi-track missile-and-drone salvo, a reported dual-track diplomatic-and-attack posture running into the weekend, and a reported energy pullback reportedly discounting the diplomatic optics — keeps LMT, GD, CVX, OKE, and CNX reading through the reported physical-crude signal, the reported regional-attack layer, and the reported UN diplomatic overhang into the Monday setup.

TRUMP-XI STATE DINNER REPORTEDLY WRAPS WITH LIMITED SUBSTANTIVE OUTCOMES BEYOND THE JANUARY 10 TRUCE RUNWAY; AI-AND-RARE-EARTHS REPORTEDLY REMAIN THE STRUCTURAL WEDGE

Per CNBC, NPR, UPI, and Bloomberg coverage of the Thursday evening East Room state dinner and its Friday follow-on framing, the reported bilateral meeting and reported state dinner between President Trump and General Secretary Xi Jinping reportedly wrapped with the reported January 10, 2027 tariff-truce extension as the reported principal substantive deliverable, and per CNN Politics coverage of the reported Xi departure sequence, the reported

visit reportedly closed with a reported tea-and-National-Archives tour rather than a reported additional deal announcement. Per NPR and CNBC coverage of the reported tech-principal guest list, the reported dinner reportedly featured Tesla's Elon Musk, Apple's Tim Cook, OpenAI's Sam Altman, and Nvidia's Jensen Huang alongside additional US technology leaders. Per Bloomberg coverage of the reported Xi remarks carried through the dinner, Xi reportedly noted that as reported leaders in AI development, China and the reported United States must reportedly ensure AI remains under human control. For FCI positioning, the composition

— a reported cordial state dinner with reported limited substantive outcomes beyond the reported January 10 runway, a reported rare-earths-and-critical-minerals structural constraint reportedly carried through prior briefs, and a reported November 10 semiconductor export-control moratorium expiration sitting behind the runway — keeps NVDA, AMD, TSM, MRVL, LRCX, KEYS, TEL, ADI, NXPI, QCOM, CRDO, FCX, and NTR reading through the reported Pacific-technology channel, the reported Fed rate path, and the reported critical-minerals thread into the Q4 balance.

On Our Radar

1. Week Ahead — September Nonfarm Payrolls Reportedly Scheduled Friday October 2 at 8:30 AM ET; ISM Manufacturing Reportedly Thursday October 1; ISM Services and Q3 Earnings Reportedly Follow. Per US economic calendar coverage carried through the CalendarX and FedRateCalc calendars, the reported September Employment Situation release from BLS is reportedly scheduled for Friday October 2 at 8:30 AM ET — the reported principal week-ahead macro catalyst into the reported October 27–28 FOMC meeting, with reported CME FedWatch odds reportedly near approximately 75.8% for a reported +25 bp move per Growbeansprout coverage. Per the same calendar coverage, the reported September ISM Manufacturing print reportedly releases Thursday October 1 at 10:00 AM ET and reported ISM Services reportedly releases the following week, framing the reported factory-and-services read that reads through the FCI Dividend industrial sleeve (CAT, PCAR, FAST, ADP, GD, LMT) and the reported Fed rate path against the reported September flash PMI beats. Per the reported Q3 earnings calendar, the reported major-bank Q3 sequence reportedly begins mid-October, framing a reported light corporate-catalyst front half followed by a reported ramp into the second half of the month. For FCI positioning, the composition — a reported jobs print into a reported hawkish-skewed Fed path, a reported ISM double-header, and a reported Q3 earnings ramp behind the front half — keeps the investment committee reading through the reported Iran-Hormuz weekend window and the reported Monday setup.

2. Iran-US Weekend Response Window — Araqchi's Reported Seven-Day Hormuz Framework Awaits US Acceptance; WSJ Reportedly Frames Trump as Rejecting a Reported Peace Plan. Per Fox News, Bloomberg, US News, and Semafor coverage of the Friday New York UNGA-sidelines sequence, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araqchi reportedly published a reported seven-day step-by-step plan under which the reported Strait of Hormuz would reportedly reopen on the reported sixth day and reported broader negotiations would reportedly begin one day later, with the timeline reportedly beginning as soon as the reported US accepts the plan. Per data drop headlines, one Reuters piece reportedly framed Iran as awaiting a US move after a reported Wall Street Journal report reportedly framed President Trump as rejecting a reported peace plan — framing a reported weekend-response constraint on any Monday reopening path. Per data drop, Friday's reported energy tape reportedly discounted a partial de-escalation path with USO approximately ↓3.11%, BNO approximately ↓3.54%, and UNG approximately ↓3.64%. For FCI positioning, the composition — a reported Iranian sequencing offer, a reported WSJ-framed Trump rejection, and a reported Friday oil pullback reportedly ahead of the weekend response window — keeps CVX, OKE, CNX, LMT, and GD reading through the reported physical-crude signal and the reported sanctions perimeter into the Monday setup.

3. Chip-and-Connector Layer Reportedly Anchors the Week's Green Close — AI-Infrastructure Trade Reportedly Back Into Favor Even as Yields Test the Rally. Per Yahoo Finance and Blockonomi coverage carried through the week and referenced in the data drop holdings news, the reported semiconductor-and-connector layer reportedly led the FCI Growth-Hybrid and Dividend tape through the week, with the reported AI-infrastructure trade reportedly back into favor even as reported Treasury yields tested the rally. Per data drop holdings news, one piece reportedly framed BofA as raising its price target on AMD, and per separate Yahoo Finance coverage carried in the drop, one piece reportedly framed NXP Semiconductors as reportedly ~7% undervalued after reported embedded-systems growth news. Per data drop, the reported enterprise-software layer reportedly diverged lower into the Friday close (with FTNT and NOW reportedly compressing per data drop), framing an intra-tech rotation from software back toward the reported chip-and-connector layer. For FCI positioning, the composition — a reported chip-and-connector weekly leadership alongside a reported enterprise-software divergence lower — keeps NVDA, AMD, TSM, MRVL, LRCX, KEYS, CRDO, TEL, ADI, NXPI, QCOM, FTNT, and NOW reading through the reported Fed rate path and the reported Pacific-technology channel into the Monday setup.

4. Michigan Sentiment Reportedly Falls Sharply to 48.1; 1-Year Inflation Expectations Reportedly Rise to 4.6%. Per University of Michigan coverage carried through Advisor Perspectives and Quartz, the reported final September sentiment print reportedly fell to approximately 48.1 (reportedly a 7.0% MoM decrease), with the reported one-year inflation expectation reportedly rising to approximately 4.6% and the reported five-year expectation reportedly at approximately 3.4%. For FCI positioning — a reported sentiment decline alongside inflation-expectations lift — keeps CHD, CL, ABT, SYK, DGX, GPC, and SPGI reading through the reported household channel into the October 2 payrolls print.